

THE DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE (1707–1740S)

SCOPE: DECLINE OF COMMAND → CHRONOLOGY FROM AURANGZEB TO → SUCCESSION INSTABILITY: THRONE BECOMES → FACTIONS AND THE SAYYID → JAGIRDARI VOCABULARY PREVENTS CATEGORY → FISCAL-MILITARY FEEDBACK LOOP

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 SCOPE: DECLINE OF COMMAND, NOT DISAPPEARANCE

DECLINE OF COMMAND, NOT DISAPPEARANCE IMPERIAL COMMAND WEAKENS; DYNASTY, TITLES AND PERSIANATE GRAMMAR ENDURE CORE WINDOW SUCCESSION, FACTIONS, JAGIRS, REGIONS AND NADIR SHAH TO THE NOT THE CLAIM
INSTANT 1707 COLLAPSE, UNIVERSAL INDIAN DECLINE OR COMPANY INEVITABILITY ANSWER RULE DISTINGUISH ENFORCEABLE AUTHORITY FROM SYMBOLIC LEGITIMACY.

1707 → imperial command weakens; dynasty, titles and Persianate grammar endure

CORE WINDOW → succession, factions, jagirs, regions and Nadir Shah to the 1740s

NOT THE CLAIM → instant 1707 collapse, universal Indian decline or Company inevitability

ANSWER RULE → distinguish enforceable authority from symbolic legitimacy.

CORE CLAIM

- 1707 → imperial command weakens; dynasty, titles and Persianate grammar endure
- CORE WINDOW → succession, factions, jagirs, regions and Nadir Shah to the 1740s

MECHANISM

- NOT THE CLAIM → instant 1707 collapse, universal Indian decline or Company inevitability
- ANSWER RULE → distinguish enforceable authority from symbolic legitimacy.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 1707 → imperial command weakens; dynasty, titles and Persianate grammar endure
- CORE WINDOW → succession, factions, jagirs, regions and Nadir Shah to the 1740s

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER RULE → distinguish enforceable authority from symbolic legitimacy.

01

STAGE 01 CHRONOLOGY FROM AURANGZEB TO THE 1740S

CHRONOLOGY FROM AURANGZEB TO THE 1740S 1707 AURANGZEB DIES BAHADUR SHAH I 1707-12 JAHANDAR SHAH 1712-13 1713 FARRUKHSIYAR RISES WITH SAYYID SUPPORT 1719 DEPOSITION AND ENTHRONEMENTS 1720 SAYYIDS FALL 1724 NIZAM'S HYDERABAD AUTONOMY

1707 Aurangzeb dies → Bahadur Shah I 1707-12 → Jahandar Shah 1712-13

1713 Farrukhsiyar rises with Sayyid support → 1719 deposition and entronements

1720 Sayyids fall → 1724 Nizam's Hyderabad autonomy → 1739 Karnal and Delhi

1740s → regional bargaining and frontier pressure; later Durrani/Panipat stay bounded.

CORE CLAIM

- 1707 Aurangzeb dies → Bahadur Shah I 1707-12 → Jahandar Shah 1712-13
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MECHANISM

- 1720 Sayyids fall → 1724 Nizam's Hyderabad autonomy → 1739 Karnal and Delhi
- 1740s → regional bargaining and frontier pressure; later Durrani/Panipat stay bounded.

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- 1707 Aurangzeb dies → Bahadur Shah I 1707-12 → Jahandar Shah 1712-13
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1740s → regional bargaining and frontier pressure; later Durrani/Panipat stay bounded.

02

STAGE 02 SUCCESSION INSTABILITY: THRONE BECOMES A PRIZE

SUCCESSION INSTABILITY THRONE BECOMES A PRIZE NO FIXED PRIMOGENITURE PRINCES MOBILISE HOUSEHOLDS AND NOBLE CLIENTS SUCCESSION WAR VICTORY REALLOCATES MANSAB, JAGIR AND OFFICE REPEATED CONTEST EMPEROR CANNOT CREDIBLY ARBITRATE ELITE COMPETITION

NO FIXED PRIMOGENITURE → princes mobilise households and noble clients

SUCCESSION WAR → victory reallocates mansab, jagir and office

REPEATED CONTEST → emperor cannot credibly arbitrate elite competition

RESULT → political transmission fails; it is a mechanism, not a lone cause.

CORE CLAIM

- NO FIXED PRIMOGENITURE → princes mobilise households and noble clients
- SUCCESSION WAR → victory reallocates mansab, jagir and office

MECHANISM

- REPEATED CONTEST → emperor cannot credibly arbitrate elite competition
- RESULT → political transmission fails; it is a mechanism, not a lone cause.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- NO FIXED PRIMOGENITURE → princes mobilise households and noble clients
- SUCCESSION WAR → victory reallocates mansab, jagir and office

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → political transmission fails; it is a mechanism, not a lone cause.

03

STAGE 03 FACTIONS AND THE SAYYID MOMENT

FACTIONS AND THE SAYYID MOMENT SHIFTING PATRONAGE FORMATIONS FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 SAYYID BROTHERS SUPPLY MILITARY-POLITICAL SUPPORT KINGMAKING EXPOSES THE THRONE'S DEPENDENCE ON COALITION CONTROL SAYYIDS REMOVED; FACTIONAL POLITICS SURVIVES THE TWO INDIVIDUALS.

CORE CLAIM

- TURANI / IRANI / AFGHAN / HINDUSTANI → shifting patronage formations

MECHANISM

- 1719 → kingmaking exposes the throne's dependence on coalition control

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TURANI / IRANI / AFGHAN / HINDUSTANI → shifting patronage formations

03

CORE CLAIM

- NO FIXED PRIMOGENITURE → princes mobilise households and noble clients
- SUCCESSION WAR → victory reallocates mansab, jagir and office

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- REPEATED CONTEST → emperor cannot credibly arbitrate elite competition
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04

STAGE 03

FACTIONS AND THE SAYYID MOMENT

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SHIFTING PATRONAGE FORMATIONS

FARRUKHSIYAR 1713

SAYYID BROTHERS SUPPLY MILITARY-POLITICAL SUPPORT

KINGMAKING EXPOSES THE THRONE'S DEPENDENCE ON COALITION CONTROL

SAYYIDS REMOVED; FACTIONAL POLITICS SURVIVES THE TWO INDIVIDUALS.

CORE CLAIM

- TURANI / IRANI / AFGHAN / HINDUSTANI → shifting patronage formations
- FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 → Sayyid Brothers supply military-political support

MECHANISM

- 1719 → kingmaking exposes the throne's dependence on coalition control
- 1720 → Sayyids removed; factional politics survives the two individuals.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TURANI / IRANI / AFGHAN / HINDUSTANI → shifting patronage formations
- FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 → Sayyid Brothers supply military-political support

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1720 → Sayyids removed; factional politics survives the two individuals.

05

STAGE 04

JAGIRDARI VOCABULARY PREVENTS CATEGORY ERRORS

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TRANSFERABLE REVENUE ASSIGNMENT, NOT PRIVATE LANDOWNERSHIP

ASSESSED CLAIM

REALISED COLLECTION

RESERVE ASSIGNABLE POOL

USABLE JAGIR SHORTAGE

NOMINAL ASSESSMENT NEVER AUTOMATICALLY MEASURES TREASURY CASH OR WELFARE.

JAMA → assessed claim

HASIL → realised collection

PAIBAQI → reserve assignable pool

BE-JAGIRI → usable jagir shortage

CORE CLAIM

- JAGIR → transferable revenue assignment, not private landownership
- JAMA → assessed claim

MECHANISM

- HASIL → realised collection
- PAIBAQI → reserve assignable pool

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- BE-JAGIRI → usable jagir shortage
- TRAP → nominal assessment never automatically measures treasury cash or welfare.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → nominal assessment never automatically measures treasury cash or welfare.

06

STAGE 05

FISCAL-MILITARY FEEDBACK LOOP

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MORE CLAIMANTS + WEAK PAIBAQI

SCRAMBLE FOR PRODUCTIVE JAGIRS

SHORT TENURE

RESISTANCE, EVASION, FLIGHT OR NEGOTIATION

LOWER HASIL

UNPAID CONTINGENTS AND WEAKER IMPERIAL SERVICE

WEAKER CONTROL

MORE CLAIMANTS + WEAK PAIBAQI → scramble for productive jagirs → SHORT TENURE / EXTRACTION → resistance, evasion, flight or negotiation → LOWER HASIL → unpaid contingents and weaker imperial service → WEAKER CONTROL → regional retention of revenue → still lower central capacity.

CORE CLAIM

- MORE CLAIMANTS + WEAK PAIBAQI → scramble for productive jagirs
- SHORT TENURE / EXTRACTION → resistance, evasion, flight or negotiation

MECHANISM

- LOWER HASIL → unpaid contingents and weaker imperial service
- WEAKER CONTROL → regional retention of revenue → still lower central capacity.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MORE CLAIMANTS + WEAK PAIBAQI → scramble for productive jagirs
- SHORT TENURE / EXTRACTION → resistance, evasion, flight or negotiation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WEAKER CONTROL → regional retention of revenue → still lower central capacity.

06

STAGE 06

AURANGZEB'S LEGACY: A WEIGHTED BACKGROUND

AURANGZEB'S LEGACY

A WEIGHTED BACKGROUND

DECCAN WAR

GARRISONS, TRANSPORT, REMOUNTS AND UNRESOLVED MARATHA CHALLENGE

TERRITORY AND CLAIMS GROW FASTER THAN RELIABLE REALISATION

NORTH ABSENCE

STRAINS OF SUPERVISION AND ARBITRATION

LEGACY MATTERED, BUT AURANGZEB ALONE CANNOT EXPLAIN POST-1707 FACTIONS

ANNEXATIONS → territory and claims grow faster than reliable realisation

DECCAN WAR → garrisons, transport, remounts and unresolved Maratha challenge

NORTH ABSENCE → strains of supervision and arbitration

QUALIFY → legacy mattered, but Aurangzeb alone cannot explain post-1707 factions or regions.

CORE CLAIM

- DECCAN WAR → garrisons, transport, remounts and unresolved Maratha challenge
- ANNEXATIONS → territory and claims grow faster than reliable realisation

MECHANISM

- NORTH ABSENCE → strains of supervision and arbitration
- QUALIFY → legacy mattered, but Aurangzeb alone cannot explain post-1707 factions or regions.

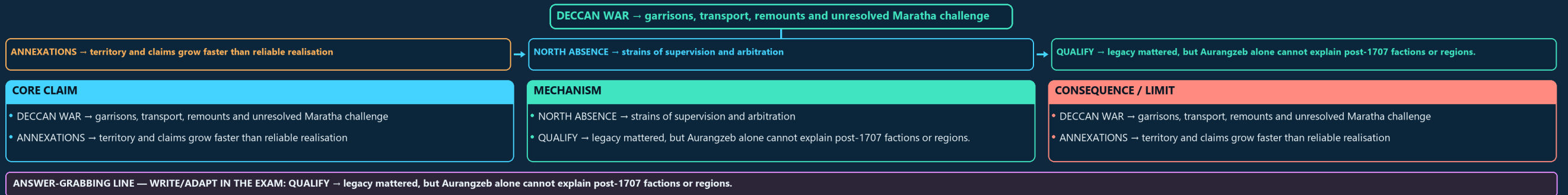
CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DECCAN WAR → garrisons, transport, remounts and unresolved Maratha challenge
- ANNEXATIONS → territory and claims grow faster than reliable realisation

06

STAGE 06 AURANGZEB'S LEGACY: A WEIGHTED BACKGROUND

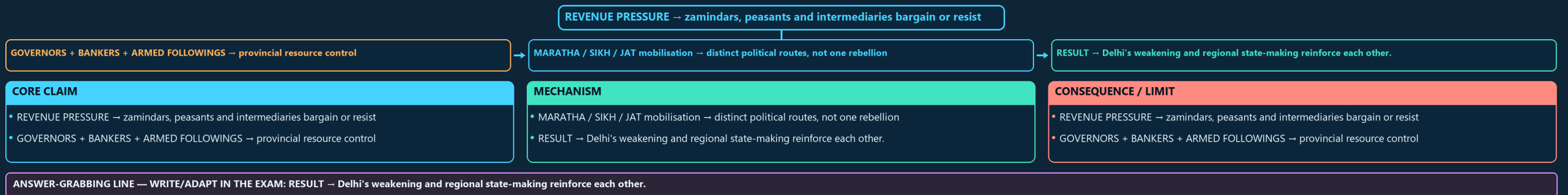
AURANGZEB'S LEGACY A WEIGHTED BACKGROUND DECCAN WAR GARRISONS, TRANSPORT, REMOUNTS AND UNRESOLVED MARATHA CHALLENGE TERRITORY AND CLAIMS GROW FASTER THAN RELIABLE REALISATION NORTH ABSENCE STRAINS OF SUPERVISION AND ARBITRATION
LEGACY MATTERED, BUT AURANGZEB ALONE CANNOT EXPLAIN POST-1707 FACTIONS



07

STAGE 07 AGRARIAN AND REGIONAL ASSERTION

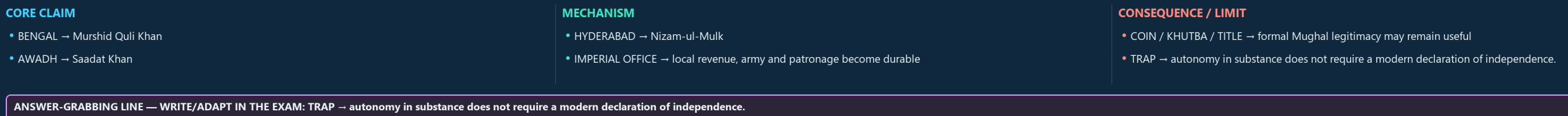
AGRARIAN AND REGIONAL ASSERTION REVENUE PRESSURE ZAMINDARS, PEASANTS AND INTERMEDIARIES BARGAIN OR RESIST GOVERNORS + BANKERS + ARMED FOLLOWINGS PROVINCIAL RESOURCE CONTROL JAT MOBILISATION DISTINCT POLITICAL ROUTES, NOT ONE REBELLION
DELHI'S WEAKENING AND REGIONAL STATE-MAKING REINFORCE EACH OTHER.



08

STAGE 08 SUCCESSOR-STATE SPECTRUM

SUCCESSOR-STATE SPECTRUM MURSHID QULI KHAN SAADAT KHAN IMPERIAL OFFICE LOCAL REVENUE, ARMY AND PATRONAGE BECOME DURABLE FORMAL MUGHAL LEGITIMACY MAY REMAIN USEFUL AUTONOMY IN SUBSTANCE DOES NOT REQUIRE A MODERN DECLARATION



09

STAGE 09 NADIR SHAH: SHOCK EXPOSES A PRIOR CRISIS

NADIR SHAH SHOCK EXPOSES A PRIOR CRISIS FRONTIER WEAKNESS + PERSIAN MILITARY CAPACITY INVASION OPPORTUNITY KARNAL, 24 FEBRUARY 1739 FRAGMENTED COMMAND LOSES TO UNIFIED COMMAND SACK, TREASURY LOSS AND PRESTIGE SHOCK; MUHAMMAD SHAH REMAINS
ACCELERANT AND REVEALER, NOT THE ORIGINAL CAUSE OF DECLINE.

